

Scoreboard	4.1 Speakers		
BRAND	Creative Inspire	Frontech	Intex
MODEL	4400	JIL-1867	IT-2880W
Features (Out Of 40)	11.91	13.69	9.85
Speaker Specifications			
Power Rating (RMS)			
Subwoofer/Center/Satellites	17/NA/6x4	NA/NA/NA	18/NA/8x4
Frequency Response	40 Hz–20 KHz	20 Hz–20 KHz	20 Hz–20 KHz
Decoder/Amplifier	None	None	None
Connectors On Speaker Set			
Digital DIN	✗	✗	✗
Auxiliary	✗	✗	✗
Coaxial/Optical In	✗/✗	✗/✗	✗/✗
Controls Provided			
Bass/Treble/Volume	✗/✗/✓	✓/✓/✓	✓/✓/✓
Surround Effects	✗	✗	✗
Others (List)	✗	Balance	✗
Bundled Accessories			
External Decoder	✗	✗	✗
Power Adapter	✗	✗	✗
Speaker Stands	✗	✗	✗
Remote Control (Wired / Wireless)	✗/✗	✗/✗	✗/✗
Batteries	NA	NA	NA
Built-in FM Tuner (Y/N)	✗	✗	✗
Build Quality (So5)			
The Knobs	2.00	2.13	1.63
The Speaker Veils	2.38	2.00	0.88
The Speaker Stands	1.75	0.00	0.00
Overall Build Quality	2.63	2.38	1.38
Performance (Out Of 45)			
In Game Sound: <i>Half-life 2</i>	1.13	1.50	1.75
DVD Movie Test			
<i>Fast And The Furious</i>	1.13	2.00	1.00
<i>Behind Enemy Lines</i>	1.25	1.50	1.13
DVD-Audio: Treble/Vocals/Bass	1.375/1.25/1.125	1.625/1.75/1.375	1.125/1.25/1.125
English Audio CD			
Track 1 (Enigma)	1.25	1.63	1.13
Track 2 (Corrs)	0.63	1.25	0.88
Hindi Audio CD			
Contemporary Track (<i>Aapki Kashish</i>)	0.88	1.50	1.00
Classical Track (Zakir Hussain)	1.88	2.00	1.38
English MP3			
Track 1 (Eagles)	0.88	1.88	1.00
Track 2 (Whitney Houston)	1.25	1.50	0.88
Hindi MP3			
Contemporary Track (<i>Aashiq Banaya Aapne</i>)	0.38	1.25	0.75
Classical Track (Bhimsen Joshi)	0.88	1.13	0.88
Special Frequency Test Files			
50 Hz / 100 Hz / 250 Hz	1.625/1.5/1	1.75/1.625/1.375	1/1/1
500 Hz / 1000 Hz / 15000 Hz	1.75/2.5/0	1.75/1.875/2.75	0.625/0.75/1.5
Power Handling Test			
Ultimate Bass Test	1.25	0.88	1.00
Ultimate Treble Test	1.25	1.38	1.38
Price Index (Out Of 20)			
Price Rs	2990	2100	2240
Overall Score (Out Of 100)			
	35.84	47.79	38.27



+ Good build quality
- Poor performance



+ Low price
- None in particular



+ None in particular
- Poor sound quality

Sound Card Matters

Now that you've got that set of speakers you've always wanted, what else is stopping you from turning that PC into a digital entertainment station? It's the sound solution a.k.a. the soundcard.

Another decision to be made is whether to invest in a discrete add-on soundcard or to utilise the Onboard Sound solution. Onboard sound is simply the audio controller that is part of the motherboard you purchase. A few years back any user remotely interested in decent sound would go with an add-on soundcard as onboard solutions just couldn't keep up.

Onboard sound has improved phenomenally and industry players like ALC and C-Media have been working hard at reducing the need to invest in an add-on soundcard. Intel has developed 'Azalia', an HD audio specification, capable of playing back more audio channels, (8 channels), at higher sound quality than other audio formats. What this means is sound with all its bells and whistles!

If you want immersive gaming and movies, and want your MP-3 playback to be truly spectacular an onboard solution just may not cut the ice. Onboard solutions as mentioned above are decent performers and nothing more. They cannot compare to a decent soundcard let alone a high end one for obvious reasons - they're integrated, to keep costs down!

The choice of whether, or not you need a soundcard is more or less up to your ears! An expensive speaker set can only do so much after all, without proper accompaniments. A entry level 4 channel soundcard costs around a thousand rupees and the higher end ones could set you back by as much as 25 grand! Generally a good buy is somewhere in-between with the decent 6 channel sets costing around Rs. 5000/-.